

you to customise shots but they do have enough to satiate the needs of the average joe. Cameras are primarily judged on their sensors, on which the quality of the image is dependant. Now manufacturers do have some tricks up their sleeves, for example, a manufacturer may claim that a certain phone has the ability to take 8 megapixel images, but this might not mean that the phone has an 8 megapixel sensor. Instead, the scene which is being photographed is broken down into pieces of say 2 megapixel resolution. This way the scene is divided into 4 parts and the 2 megapixel sensor takes 4 photos and then combines them to give you an eight megapixel image. Not that most people would be able to notice the difference, but in case you are going in for a phone with the camera being a priority then it is something that you need to keep in mind. Also, most phones these days to have two cameras, one in the front facing the user and the other on the back. The front facing camera is used for video chatting primarily and the rear facing camera is for everything else that you could do with a camera. You need not worry much about the native photo editing capabilities of your phone or tablet as there are plenty of applications available to do the same.

As far as the camera flash is concerned there are primarily two types :

- ▶ LED
- ▶ XENON

The LED flash is what's present on almost all phone in the budget and mid-range categories. It's not bright but that helps save a lot of power and subsequently you can get a lot more shots from your phone, you'd even run out of space on your memory card before the phone battery runs out. The XENON flash is what you need if you want images to be more lifelike and not washed out. This is because the colour temperature of a XENON flash is closer to the colour temperature of sunlight, which means your photos seem closer to what you'd get from a proper camera. XENON flashes consume a lot more power and thus require charging up, i.e. they have a capacitor hooked up to them. So the time gap between two consecutive shots is determined by the time taken to charge up the capacitor, which means you don't have the luxury of taking rapid fire shots which is possible even with the cheapest point and shoot. However, a new patent awarded to Google could see things change as they've proposed an array of flashes. Not only can each individual flash charge up and fire independently, but with the combination of all flashes you can come up with varying intensities of brightness.